Report of attendance for the training school “Computer Vision in Archaeology” 14th –18th September 2026

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I spend a week in Brno to take part in a training school on Computer Vision in Archaeology. While I did not have any specific topic or project in mind, I was simply curious and excited to learn as much as possible about this field and this training school seemed like a great opportunity to do so. During the week we worked with different datasets which brought a variety of topics and challenges and showed us different ways of dealing with them. At first, I was a bit worried that I might be left behind and wont be able to keep up with the others since I did not have any previous knowledge and my coding skills were only basic, but it eventually turned out to be a really positive and educational experience and I needed up learning a lot more than I expected.



Day 1

The first day started with a presentation introducing the concept of computer vision in archaeology and its application for different goals and purposes, as well as the challenges that come with working with visual data. We also covered topics like coding with agents and went through Python basics that were relevant for computer vision applications. In addition to that, we also had practical sessions, and multiple discussion rounds in small groups which was a great opportunity to exchange ideas with the other participants and explore questions and different perspectives.

The day ended with an icebreaker event where the organizers had planned a very welcoming evening that gave everyone a chance to talk, share experiences and get to know each other in a

more casual setting. It was a great way to end the first day, and I ended up making some great friends.

Day 2

The first part of the second day focused on working with an Artefacts dataset. We looked at how archaeological artefacts can be identified and classified from photographs and learned more about the process of annotating images. We also discussed some of the difficulties that can come with this, such as deciding how objects should be labelled. The practical sessions were also really useful as we got to work with CVAT and OpenCV.

In the afternoon, we had the chance to listen to the other participants present their own projects and explain what they were working on. I really enjoyed seeing the variety of topics and approaches, especially the once related to analysing lithic tools.

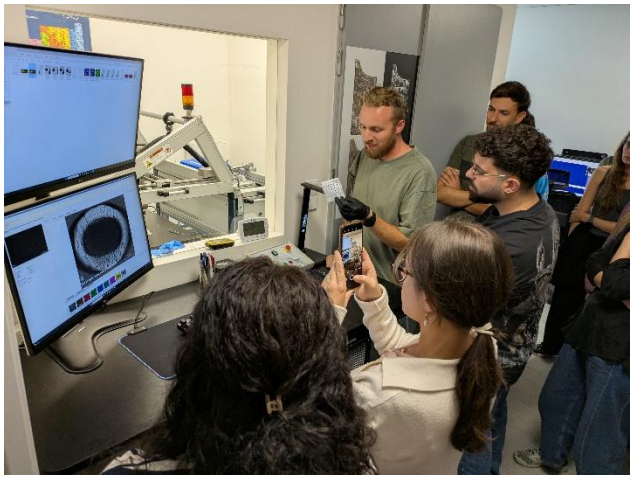
After that, a guided tour of the city had been organised for us. It was a great chance to explore the city and learn more about its history. I really liked Brno for its rich history, the old buildings that are still so well preserved and the lively streets.

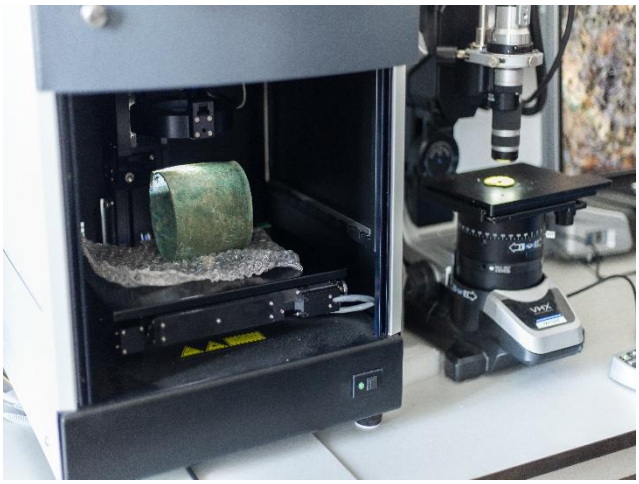


Day 3

The next day started with an introduction to microscopic imagery and the challenges that can come with working with complex data like that. We also discussed the importance of preparing the data properly since differences in image quality, size, brightness or colour can affect the results.

During the second part of the day, the organisers kindly offered us a tour of the institute´s lab. We had the chance to check out some of the impressive machines and equipment used for arachnological research as well as talk with the professionals that explained their work for us.





Day 4

The fourth day started with a session on satellite imagery, where we worked with example images from a dataset and processed them to make certain details more visible. I found this part particularly interesting and was excited to learn about it and try it out myself on other data.

In the second part of the day, we focused on rock art datasets which was also presented an interesting set of images with different set of challenges and approaches to consider. The organizer also kindly offered us a tour of the institute's library to take a look at its archive collection.

Day 5

The last day focused on working with a dataset of ancient coins. We also learned about large language models (LLMs) and the concept of a black box, where we can see the input and output without necessarily knowing exactly how the model reaches its results. The session also introduced us to Hugging Face, where we learned how to browse available machine learning models and find ones suited to different tasks. This gave us a better idea of how existing models can be accessed and used in our own projects.

Overall, my time in Brno went by way too fast. The training school definitely exceeded my expectations, and I ended up having a lot of fun and learning so much more than I had expected. While one week was not enough to make me an expert in machine learning and computer vision, it definitely made me more curious about the field and motivated me to learn more and apply these methods in my future research.

I would also like to thank the organisers, who did an amazing job putting everything together and made sure that everyone felt welcome and right at home.